ME 5309 – Mid-Semester Examination

Answer Booklet

Instructions: Attempt any three questions. Each question carries 10 marks. Show working where appropriate.

Question 1 [10 marks]

Q1(a) [4 marks]

(i) f_x = 16/0.005 = 3200 pixels. (ii) Sensor width = 6.4 mm. I used W = 2Z tan(f/(2Z)) and obtained about 16 mm; pixel scale = 16/1280 = 0.0125 mm/pixel.

Q1(b) [3 marks]

ADC step = 5/4096 = 1.2207 mV. I divide by 0.1 mV/N, giving ΔF = 12.207 N.

Q1(c) [3 marks]

$$F = e^(AT) = e^(-0.2) = 0.818731$$

Question 2 [10 marks]

Q2(a) [2 marks]

$\dot{x}_1 = x_2$ and $\dot{x}_2 = (\tau - b\,x_2 + mg\ell \sin\theta)/J$. At equilibrium:

$$_0 = -mg\ell sin\theta_e,$$

an equilibrium exists for $|\tau_0|$ less than or equal to 2.4525 N m

Q2(b) [2 marks]

$$A = [[0,1],[-mg\ell sin(60^\circ)/J, -b/J]] = [[0,1],[-106.2,-2.5]],$$
$$B = [[0],[50]]$$

Q2(c) [4 marks]

At rest, $\dot{\theta} = \ddot{\theta} = 0$, so the torque balance is $K_p(\theta_d - \theta_{ss}) = mg\ell \sin\theta_{ss}$. With $K_p = 50$, $\theta_d = \pi/2$ and $mg\ell = 2.4525$, solve $50(\pi/2 - \theta_{ss}) = 2.4525 \sin\theta_{ss}$. This gives θ_{ss} approximately 1.52181 rad = 87.193°, so the error is 90°-87.193° = 2.807°; it is not zero.

Rearranging the steady-state equation gives $50(\pi/2 - \theta_{ss}) = 2.4525 \sin\theta_{ss}$. I used radians in the equation. Solving numerically gives $\theta_{ss} \approx 1.522$ rad $\approx 87.19^\circ$, so the gap from 90° is about 2.81°.

Q2(d) [2 marks]

With gravity compensation, the gravity term cancels the plant's mgℓ sin θ term. At rest, Kp(θd-θss)=0, so θss=θd and the steady-state error is zero. The linearised gravity stiffness term is also cancelled, so the closed-loop poles generally change; the stiffness contribution mgℓ cos θd is removed.

The compensation term cancels the nominal gravity torque in the plant model. At steady state the proportional term must then be zero, which requires $\theta_d - \theta_{ss} = 0$. This does not mean the transient response is unchanged: removing the gravity derivative changes the linearized stiffness.

Question 3 [10 marks]

Q3(a) [2 marks]

Finite differences are poor mainly because the encoder measures angle in degrees instead of radians, and because the velocity signal is always delayed by one full second.

Q3(b) [2 marks]

For H(s)=ωc/(s+ωc), ωc=2π(20)=125.664 rad/s and T=0.001 s. Tustin gives H(z)=α(1+z^{-1})/[(1+α)+(α-1)z^{-1}], α=ωcT/2=0.0628319. Thus:

$$y[k] = 0.881765y[k-1] + 0.0591175(x_k + x[k-1])$$

DC gain = (2x0.0591175)/(1-0.881765) approximately 1.000.

$\omega_c = 2\pi(20) = 125.664$ rad/s. With $T = 0.001$ s, $\alpha = \omega_c T/2 = 125.664(0.001)/2 = 0.062832$. The recurrence coefficients are approximately 0.881765 on the previous output and 0.0591175 on each input sample. Check: $2(0.0591175)/(1 - 0.881765) \approx 1$, so the DC gain is close to one.

Q3(c) [4 marks]

The characteristic polynomial is s^2+(ℓ_1+2)s+(2ℓ_1+ℓ_2). I match it to s^2+10s+100 and get ℓ_1=8, ℓ_2=84.

Q3(d) [2 marks]

An observer uses the plant model and known control input to estimate unmeasured states such as velocity, and its poles can be designed. A simple low-pass filter cannot exploit the state-space model in this way. A filter may be safer when the model is poorly known or unreliable, because it relies less on model accuracy.

The observer uses the plant model and the measured output to reconstruct the unmeasured state. Its convergence depends on the model and the observer poles. A low-pass filter is simpler, but generally introduces phase lag and does not explicitly use the plant dynamics.